

SkillPassport AI

Investor Q&A Guide & Founder Strategy

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EXECUTIVE OVERVIEW: WHY Q&A IS MORE IMPORTANT THAN THE PITCH

Investors often spend **5–10 minutes listening** to your pitch and **20–30 minutes asking questions**. They are not trying to trip you up—they are testing whether you deeply understand your business model, customer incentives, and market dynamics. Below is the definitive guide to the 20 most critical investor questions, complete with honest, investor-friendly responses.

1. Core Product & Identity

Q1. "In one sentence, what are you building?"

"SkillPassport AI is building the trusted digital identity and infrastructure for technical talent, where verified work replaces traditional resumes and connects developers with companies, universities, investors, and opportunities."

Strategic Tip: Keep it crisp, memorable, and framed as infrastructure rather than just a feature.

Q2. "Isn't this just another recruitment platform?"

Why they ask: They want to see if you have a unique position and defensible market layer.

"Recruitment is only one application of our platform. Our core product is the Skill Passport—a lifelong, verified professional identity built from real contributions. Recruitment is simply one way that identity creates value."

Q3. "Why would anyone leave LinkedIn or GitHub?"

Why they ask: Testing whether you are foolishly taking on tech giants directly or positioning as an integrative layer.

"We don't want them to. GitHub is the home for code, and LinkedIn is the home for networking. SkillPassport connects verified achievements from multiple sources into one trusted professional identity. We complement existing platforms instead of replacing them."

Q4. "What problem are you solving?"

"The biggest problem isn't finding developers—it's trusting them. Today, technical evidence is scattered across many platforms, making hiring slow and inefficient. We unify verified work into one trusted identity."

Strategic Tip: Emphasize trust and speed over sheer candidate quantity.

Q5. "Who is your customer?"

"Initially, our paying customers are technology companies hiring early-career developers. Our users are developers, but our first revenue comes from companies looking for faster and more reliable hiring."

Strategic Tip: Differentiate clearly between 'users' (developers) and 'buyers' (tech companies).

2. Roadmap, Business Model & Traction

Q6. "What will you build first?"

Why they ask: Investors test your discipline and prioritization. Founders who try to build everything at once fail.

AVOID

DON'T SAY: "Everything across our 5-year roadmap."

RECOMMENDED ANSWER

SAY INSTEAD: "Phase 1 focuses exclusively on three core pillars: (1) Skill Passport, (2) Verified Project Portfolio, and (3) Recruiter Dashboard. Everything else is part of our long-term expansion roadmap."

Strategic Tip: Showing laser focus builds high investor confidence.

Q7. "How do you make money?"

"Our first revenue comes from enterprise recruiter subscriptions. As the platform grows, we'll expand into premium developer services, sponsored technical challenges, and marketplace partnerships."

Strategic Tip: Keep the monetization pitch clean and focused on standard B2B SaaS first.

Q8. "What makes you different?"

"Existing platforms solve individual problems. We connect the entire developer journey into one trusted identity. Our differentiation isn't a feature—it's the professional identity layer."

Strategic Tip: Highlight the network effect of the identity layer.

Q9. "What is Proof of Skill?"

"Proof of Skill is our long-term vision for verifying technical ability through evidence instead of claims. It combines verified projects, deployments, technical challenges, certifications, and professional contributions into a trusted record that organizations can rely on."

Strategic Tip: Avoid claiming this is already an industry standard; frame it as your visionary protocol.

Q10. "Why would companies trust your score?"

"We don't ask companies to trust a black-box score. We provide transparent evidence behind every profile—projects, deployments, challenge results, and verified contributions—so organizations can make informed decisions."

Strategic Tip: Transparency beats black-box AI algorithms in high-stakes enterprise hiring.

3. Distribution, Defense & Risk Management

Q11. "How will you get your first 10,000 users?"

Why they ask: Testing your bottom-up acquisition strategy.

"We'll start with engineering colleges and developer communities, offering free Skill Passports and portfolio hosting. Once we establish a strong developer base, we onboard companies looking for verified early-career talent."

Strategic Tip: Focus on campus & developer community channels.

Q12. "How will you compete with companies that have billions of users?"

"We're not competing on scale from day one. We're solving a specific problem they don't own: unified technical identity. We focus on one niche, validate it, and expand gradually."

Strategic Tip: Niche dominance precedes broad platform scale.

Q13. "What if GitHub launches the same feature?"

Why they ask: Classic 'Big Tech copycat' question.

"GitHub owns repositories, not professional identity across the entire ecosystem. Our platform integrates projects, internships, certifications, deployments, challenges, universities, and hiring. Our value comes from connecting the ecosystem, not from one feature."

Strategic Tip: Emphasize multi-platform cross-integrations.

Q14. "Why now?"

"Hiring is shifting from resume-based evaluation to evidence-based hiring. Companies increasingly value practical skills, open-source contributions, and deployed projects. The industry is ready for a trusted identity layer."

Strategic Tip: Point to macro trends: rise of AI code generation, resume inflation, evidence-based evaluation.

Q15. "What's your biggest risk?"

Why they ask: Investors appreciate founders who recognize real risks without sugarcoating.

"Adoption. That's why we're not launching as a full marketplace. We first create value for developers with Skill Passports and verified portfolios before expanding to companies and other stakeholders."

Strategic Tip: Demonstrates pragmatic risk mitigation tactics.

4. Funding, Team & Investment Case

Q16. "How much funding do you need?"

"We're seeking enough funding to build and validate Phase 1 over the next 12–18 months, focusing on product development, infrastructure, early partnerships, and customer validation. The exact amount depends on the scope agreed with our investors."

Strategic Tip: Tie capital ask directly to 12–18 month milestones, not arbitrary figures.

Q17. "What's your long-term vision?"

"Our long-term vision is to make SkillPassport the trusted professional identity for technical talent worldwide, similar to how GitHub became the standard for code collaboration."

Strategic Tip: Provide an inspiring North Star comparison.

Q18. "Why are you the right team?"

Why they ask: Founders often struggle here by overselling expertise.

"We're technical students who have personally experienced fragmented portfolios, repeated verification, and hiring challenges. We're building a platform to solve a problem we've lived ourselves, and our technical background allows us to build and iterate quickly."

Strategic Tip: Highlight founder-market fit and living the problem firsthand.

Q19. "If I give you INR 2 crore tomorrow, what happens?"

"We'll focus on one outcome: proving that a verified Skill Passport improves developer visibility and helps companies hire more efficiently. Success for us is product-market validation, not building every planned feature."

Strategic Tip: Emphasize milestone achievement over capital consumption.

Q20. "Why should I invest in you?"

Why they ask: The final closing statement.

"Because we're not trying to build another recruitment platform. We're building the trust layer that connects the fragmented developer ecosystem. If we succeed, recruitment becomes just one application of a much larger identity network."

Strategic Tip: Leave them with the category-defining vision.

5. Reverse Q&A: Questions You Should Ask Investors

A good pitch is never a one-sided interrogation—it is a two-sided conversation. At the conclusion of your presentation, turn the table with these strategic questions to signal maturity, coachability, and alignment:

1. "What concerns you most about this idea?"

Allows you to address hidden hesitations before leaving the room.

2. "If you were building this company, what would you focus on first?"

Tests strategic alignment and extracts high-value investor insights.

3. "Do you see this as a recruitment company or an identity infrastructure company?"

Checks whether they grasp your true category positioning.

4. "What milestone would convince you that we've found product-market fit?"

Sets clear criteria for follow-up conversations and funding rounds.

GOLDEN RULE: DON'T DEFEND EVERY IDEA—SHOW DISCIPLINE

If an investor critiques a part of your pitch (e.g., *"I think your cloud marketplace is unnecessary"*), **do not argue or defensively justify it.**

The Ideal Response:

"That's valuable feedback. The cloud marketplace is part of our long-term vision, but our immediate focus is strictly on the Skill Passport and identity layer. We are disciplined about validating one core product before expanding."

Why this wins: This answer demonstrates emotional maturity, coachability, and operational discipline—qualities that early-stage investors value just as much as the product idea itself.